

BusyBee: Contextual Inquiry Observations

CSC 310 Human-Computer Interaction | Team: Omar Naguib, Nolan Jarvinen, Evan Wilkin

Participants

Subject	Who they are	Observed by
Subject 1	Retired, six to eight flights a year	Omar Naguib
Subject 2	Student, studies off campus every day	Omar Naguib
Subject 3	Dines out every three weeks, two young children	Evan Wilkin
Subject 4	Out three to four times a day, errand-driven	Evan Wilkin
Subject 5	Out once or twice a week, patient planner	Evan Wilkin
Subject 6	Out most days, strongly crowd-averse	Nolan Jarvinen
Subject 7	Out daily: gym, stores, golf, long drives	Nolan Jarvinen

The three observation queries

1	Demonstrate how you currently gauge busyness of a location.
2	Demonstrate how you currently notify others how busy a location is.
3	Demonstrate how you prefer to plan before going out.

Observation 1 Demonstrate how you currently gauge busyness of a location.

Subject 1 Retired, six to eight flights a year

1. Picks the airport as the case that matters, rather than a restaurant.
2. Opens the airport's published security wait time on his phone.
3. Sets it aside, based on an earlier trip where the posted figure was well short of the actual wait.
4. Notes that the posted figure carries no indication of when it was last updated.
5. Asks staff who are at the airport all morning, such as a shuttle driver, which terminal is worst that day.
6. For a restaurant, calls the venue and asks how long the wait is.

Subject 2 Student, studies off campus every day

1. Starts the check after leaving class, while already walking.
2. Opens Google Maps and reads the popular times graph for the current hour.
3. Treats it as a general weekly pattern rather than a reading of today, and points out that it does not account for exam periods.
4. Texts someone from her course who is already at the library to ask whether there are free tables.
5. Checks recent Instagram posts tagged at the venue for a photo from that day.
6. If nothing comes back, goes to the venue and checks in person.

Subject 3 Dines out every three weeks, two young children

1. Chooses the venue first, then checks busyness afterwards to set expectations.
2. Reads the predicted busyness on the Google listing. Describes the check as casual and infrequent.
3. For a cinema, opens the booking page and uses the number of seats already sold.
4. Weighs how much the family wants to go against the likely wait, with two young children factored in.

Subject 4 Out three to four times a day, errand-driven

1. Checks the Gym's app to see the range of busyness. This is the only source used.
2. Picks a time from the graph rather than a different venue, usually as early in the day as possible.
3. Goes, accepting that it may be busier than the graph predicted.
4. Confirms how busy it actually is only on arrival.

Subject 5 Out once or twice a week, patient planner

1. Searches the venue on Google and reads the wait time shown on the listing.
2. Calls the restaurant directly if it is somewhere the group particularly wants to go.
3. Treats the result as an expectation to arrive with rather than a decision to make, and goes either way.

Subject 6 Out most days, strongly crowd-averse

1. Checks nothing before leaving. No app, site or phone call is used at this stage.
2. Chooses a time to go based on her own experience of when that place is quiet.
3. Assesses how busy it is on arrival, and decides at that point whether to go in or go elsewhere.

Subject 7 Out daily: gym, stores, golf, long drives

1. Opens Google Maps or Apple Maps first, for drive time and traffic.
2. Checks the restaurant's website or a reservation platform for open slots.
3. Calls the venue to ask whether they have tables open.
4. For downtown Detroit, factors in parking alongside the venue itself.
5. For the gym, the store or the golf course, skips the check and predicts from experience.

Observation 2 Demonstrate how you currently notify others how busy a location is.

Subject 1 Retired, six to eight flights a year

1. Uses the family group message. Nothing else.
2. Sends a short warning once he is through a line, telling the others to allow more time.
3. Sends it only to family, and only about places he has just been.
4. Does not post anywhere public, citing no known audience and no benefit to him.

Subject 2 Student, studies off campus every day

1. Uses the group chat with her friends.
2. Photographs the room and sends the photo with a short warning not to come.
3. Sends it from the venue, within seconds of seeing it.
4. Would not write a review. Treats it as a message to friends rather than information for strangers.

Subject 3 Dines out every three weeks, two young children

1. Sends a one to one text, either to whoever they are meeting or to a friend going separately.
2. Sends it before the other person leaves, so they can adjust.
3. Does not post publicly.

Subject 4 Out three to four times a day, errand-driven

1. Has no routine for this, and recalls doing it roughly once.
2. Mentions it in person rather than sending anything.

Subject 5 Out once or twice a week, patient planner

1. Texts ahead when meeting someone, to say what the place is like.
2. Gives a prediction from memory when asked about a restaurant later.
3. Nothing is written down or kept.

Subject 6 Out most days, strongly crowd-averse

1. Raises it in conversation rather than sending a message.
2. Only brings it up when she already knows the other person is considering going.
3. Uses Waze, where other drivers report conditions, and treats that as the same kind of exchange.

Subject 7 Out daily: gym, stores, golf, long drives

1. Arrives first, which is the usual case.
2. Texts the person they are meeting to say it is busy, so the two of them can decide whether to go elsewhere.
3. Does not post publicly, and would want to know how false reports and moderation are handled first.

Observation 3 Demonstrate how you prefer to plan before going out.

Subject 1 Retired, six to eight flights a year

1. Separates local dinner from flying, and plans them differently.
2. Local dinner: no planning. Goes, then sits at the bar or moves on if there is a wait.
3. Flying: plans the night before, working backwards from boarding time to a time to leave the house.
4. Adds around forty five minutes on top for holidays or a tight connection.
5. On the morning, checks the posted wait time and texts family, then adjusts the leave time if needed.

Subject 2 Student, studies off campus every day

1. Separates studying from going out.
2. Studying: no planning. Leaves class and walks to whichever place is nearest.
3. Going out: settles it in the group chat, which takes about twenty minutes across six people.
4. One person suggests a venue, another checks Maps, another rules it out based on a recent visit.
5. Once the group agrees, the decision is not reopened.

Subject 3 Dines out every three weeks, two young children

1. Chooses the venue, without researching it further.
2. Runs a light busyness check afterwards.
3. Sets the limit by who is coming. With two young children, any wait is too long.
4. Keeps a rough alternative in mind rather than a researched one.

Subject 4 Out three to four times a day, errand-driven

1. Always plans ahead, and works out what is needed before leaving.
2. Picks an off-peak time from the predicted busyness graph, such as the gym early in the morning.
3. Leaves with a fixed limit of about ten minutes, applied on arrival.

Subject 5 Out once or twice a week, patient planner

1. Decides the venue well ahead of going.
2. Runs a light Google check, mostly to know what to expect.
3. Plans to wait rather than to switch. Fifteen minutes is the normal wait, and twenty at the table before flagging someone down.
4. Has a fallback venue in mind but rarely uses it.

Subject 6 Out most days, strongly crowd-averse

1. Plans the trip in advance, including where she is going and roughly how long she will be there.
2. Chooses a time when fewer people are likely to be out.
3. Takes no busyness information with her, since nothing is checked beforehand.

4. Leaves on arrival if it is crowded. Over about thirty minutes at a restaurant is too long, and a packed cinema is enough to change the plan. Still goes into a busy store.

Subject 7 Out daily: gym, stores, golf, long drives

1. Plans one main activity for the day, such as golf, the gym or the store.
2. Checks Maps for drive time and traffic before leaving, particularly for longer drives.
3. Books or calls ahead if the main activity is a restaurant.
4. Leaves whatever follows unplanned, and decides in the moment.
5. Applies a cutoff of around forty five minutes at a restaurant, adjusted by how hungry they are.